

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 156

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to recognize Johnnie Sharp, Jr., on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, our nation was conceived by individuals who were willing to sacrifice their personal concerns to ensure the public safety and welfare, and the Volunteer State is especially proud to be the home of so many valiant individuals; and

WHEREAS, one such person is Johnnie Sharp, Jr., who took his much-deserved retirement from the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) on January 31, 2025; and

WHEREAS, in August 2022, FBI Director Christopher Wray named Johnnie Sharp, Jr., as the Assistant Director of the IT Infrastructure Division at the FBI's campus in Huntsville, Alabama; he most recently served as special agent in charge of the Birmingham Field Office in Alabama; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Sharp is the first person to hold an Assistant Director position in Huntsville, where the FBI is locating some of its technical and specialized training activities; and

WHEREAS, Johnnie Sharp, Jr., joined the FBI as a special agent in 1998 and was assigned to the Pittsburgh Field Office to investigate counterintelligence and counterterrorism matters; he also served as a firearms instructor and on the SWAT Team; and

WHEREAS, in 2005, he was promoted to Supervisory Special Agent and transferred to one of the International Terrorism sections in the Counterterrorism Division at FBI Headquarters in Washington, D.C.; and

WHEREAS, in 2008, Mr. Sharp was named a Squad Supervisor of the Counterintelligence, Cyber, and Technical programs in the Jackson Field Office in Mississippi; and

WHEREAS, he served for several months as the FBI's Deputy On-scene Commander in Iraq in 2009, in which position he was responsible for leading counterterrorism operations; and

WHEREAS, after returning to Mississippi, Johnnie Sharp, Jr., was promoted in 2013 to Assistant Special Agent in Charge of the Jackson Field Office's National Security Branch, where he managed the Cyber, Counterintelligence, Counterterrorism, Weapons of Mass Destruction, Crisis Management, and Technical programs; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Sharp was promoted to Section Chief of the Technical Surveillance Section in the Operational Technology Division at Headquarters in 2015; as Section Chief, he provided management over eight technical units responsible for evidence and intelligence collection capabilities; and

WHEREAS, during his estimable career, Johnnie Sharp, Jr., served temporary FBI assignments in London, Cairo, New Delhi, and Riyadh, Saudi Arabia; he was selected to serve as the Special Agent in Charge of the Birmingham Field Office in Alabama in 2017; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Sharp holds a bachelor's degree from the University of Tennessee; prior to beginning his distinguished tenure with the FBI, he served as a deputy sheriff and police officer in Knoxville; and

WHEREAS, Johnnie Sharp, Jr., epitomizes the spirit and commitment that are characteristic of a true Tennessean, and his professionalism and dedication to public service are evident to all who know him; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to recognize and applaud Mr. Sharp for his dedication to our nation and the State of Tennessee and its citizens; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Johnnie Sharp, Jr., on the occasion of his retirement from the Federal Bureau of Investigation, thank him for his meritorious service, and extend to him our heartfelt wishes for a happy and fulfilling retirement and every continued success in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.